



DELHI PUBLIC SCHOOL NEWTOWN
SESSION 2025-2026
FINAL EXAMINATION

CLASS: VIII
SUBJECT: ENGLISH PAPER I (SET B)

FULL MARKS: 80
TIME: 2 HOURS

Answers to this Paper must be written on the paper provided separately.

You will not be allowed to write during the first 10 minutes.

This time is to be spent in reading the question paper.

The time given at the head of this Paper is the time allowed for writing the answers.

Attempt all five questions.

The intended marks for questions or parts of questions are given in brackets [].

This paper consists of seven printed pages.

Question 1

Write a composition (300-350 words) on any one of the following:

[20]

i) 'Screens are killing children's imagination.' Express your views either for or against this statement.

ii) "Where there is a will, there is a way". Write an original short story based on this proverb.

iii) Describe the Annual Sports Day in your school held last year where you participated in an event. Mention the atmosphere in the field, some important events, inspiring speeches and the enthusiasm among the participants. Also share your feelings stating how the programme upheld the true spirit of sportsmanship.

iv) Narrate an experience when you decided to speak the truth despite knowing that the consequences might be unfavourable to you. What were the emotions that you experienced during this time? What helped you remain firm in your decision? How did the outcome impact your outlook on life?

v) Study the picture given below. Write a story or a description or an account of what it suggests to you. Your composition may be about the subject of the picture or you may take suggestions from it; however, there must be a clear connection between the picture and your composition.



Question 2

Select any one of the following:

[10]

i) You were held up at the airport for a night due to a sudden airline strike. Write a letter to your friend narrating the incident.

ii) You want to start a new club in your school. Write a letter to your Principal requesting permission to start the club. Explain your role in it and give reasons to prove that the club will be beneficial for the school.

Question 3

i) Your school is organizing an Inter-School Stand-up Comedy competition. Write a notice informing the students from classes VI to VIII to participate in the competition.

[5]

ii) Your school is organizing an Inter-School Stand-up Comedy competition. Write an email to a renowned comedian inviting him/her to judge the event.

[5]

Question 4

Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow:

My five years' old daughter Mini cannot live without chattering. I really believe that in all her life she has not wasted a minute in silence. Her mother is often vexed at this, and would stop her prattle, but I would not. To see Mini quiet is unnatural, and I cannot bear it long. And so my own talk with her is always lively.

One morning, for instance, when I was in the midst of the seventeenth chapter of my new novel, my little Mini stole into the room, and putting her hand into mine, said: "Father! Ramdayal the door-keeper calls a crow a krow! He doesn't know anything, does he?"

Before I could explain to her the differences of language in this world, she was embarked on the full tide of another subject. "What do you think, Father? Bhola says there is an elephant in the clouds, blowing water out of his trunk, and that is why it rains!"

And then, *darting* off anew, while I sat still making ready some reply to this last saying: "Father! what relation is Mother to you?"

"My dear little sister in the law!" I murmured involuntarily to myself, but with a grave face I contrived to answer: "Go and play with Bhola, Mini! I am busy!"

The window of my room overlooks the road. The child had seated herself at my feet near my table, and was playing softly, drumming on her knees. I was hard at work on my seventeenth chapter, where Pratap Singh, the hero, had just caught Kanchanlata, the heroine, in his arms, and was about to escape with her by the third-story window of the castle, when all of a sudden Mini left her play, and ran to the window, crying: "A Kabuliwallah! a Kabuliwallah!" Sure enough in the street below was a Kabuliwallah, passing slowly along. He wore the loose, soiled clothing of his people, with a tall turban; there was a bag on his back, and he carried boxes of grapes in his hand.

I cannot tell what were my daughter's feelings at the sight of this man, but she began to call him loudly. "Ah!" I thought, "he will come in, and my seventeenth chapter will never be finished!" At which exact moment the Kabuliwallah turned, and looked up at the child. When she saw this, overcome by terror, she fled to her mother's protection and disappeared. She had a blind belief that inside the bag, which the big man carried, there were perhaps two or three other children like herself. The *pedlar* meanwhile entered my doorway and greeted me with a smiling face.

So precarious was the position of my hero and my heroine, that my first impulse was to stop and buy something, since the man had been called. I made some small purchases, and a conversation began about Abdurrahman, the Russians, the English, and the Frontier Policy.

As he was about to leave, he asked: "And where is the little girl, sir?"

And I, thinking that Mini must get rid of her false fear, had her brought out.

She stood by my chair, and looked at the Kabuliwallah and his bag. He offered her nuts and raisins, but she would not be tempted, and only clung closer to me, with all her doubts increased. This was their first meeting.

One morning, however, not many days later, as I was leaving the house, I was startled to find

Mini, seated on a bench near the door, laughing and talking, with the great Kabuliwallah at her feet. In all her life, it appeared, my small daughter had never found so patient a listener, except her father. And already the corner of her little sari was stuffed with almonds and raisins, the gift of her visitor. "Why did you give her those?" I said, and taking out an eight-anna bit, I handed it to him. The man accepted the money without demur, and slipped it into his pocket.

Alas, on my return an hour later, I found the unfortunate coin had made twice its own worth of trouble! For the Kabuliwallah had given it to Mini; and her mother, catching sight of the bright round object, had pounced on the child with: "Where did you get that eight-anna bit?"

"The Kabuliwallah gave it me," said Mini cheerfully.

"The Kabuliwallah gave it you!" cried her mother much shocked. "O Mini! how could you take it from him?"

I, entering at the moment, saved her from impending disaster, and proceeded to make my own inquiries.

(*Kabuliwala* by Rabindranath Tagore)

i) For each word given below choose the correct meaning (as used in the passage) from the options provided: [2]

1. *darting*

- a) creeping
- b) loitering along
- c) dashing
- d) ceasing

2. *pedlar*

- a) consumer
- b) street trader
- c) employer
- d) client

ii) Which word in the passage means the opposite of '*elective*'? [1]

- a) involuntarily
- b) vexed
- c) instance
- d) impulse

iii) Answer the following questions briefly in your words:

- a) Why does the narrator prefer Mini to chatter rather than be quiet? [2]
- b) Why did Mini first run away from the Kabuliwallah but later sit and talk with him? [2]
- c) What does the mother's reaction to the eight-anna coin reveal about social attitudes or fears? [2]
- d) Why does Mini's father finally bring her out to meet the Kabuliwallah despite her fear? [2]

e) Suggest an alternate title to the story and justify your choice. [1]

iv) In not more than 50 words describe the first encounter of the little girl with Kabuliwallah. [8]

Question 5

i) Fill in each of the numbered blanks with the correct form of the word given in the brackets. Do not copy the passage but write in correct serial order the word or phrase appropriate to the blank space. [$\frac{1}{2} \times 8 = 4$]

Example: (0) *know*

I was homesick during the whole of my term at St. Peter's. Homesickness is a bit like seasickness. You don't ____ (0) ____ (*know*) how awful it is till you get it and when you do, it (1) ____ (*hit*) you right in the top of the stomach and you (2) ____ (*want*) to die. The only comfort is that both homesickness and seasickness are instantly curable. The first (3) ____ (*go*) away the moment you walk out of the school grounds and the second (4) ____ (*forget*) as soon as the ship enters the port. I was so (5) ____ (*devastating*) homesick during my first two weeks that I set about (6) ____ (*devise*) a stunt for getting myself sent back home, even if it (7) ____ (*be*) only for a few days. My idea was that I should all of a sudden develop an attack of acute appendicitis. I (8) ____ (*have*) sound reasons for trying it out.

ii) Fill in the blanks with suitable words: [$\frac{1}{2} \times 8 = 4$]

- a) The dance reality show will be telecast ____ Monday.
- b) We tried to dissuade Rita ____ quitting her job based on an impulse.
- c) She has not been to her home town ____ December 10, 2020.
- d) Citizens of a country must abide ____ the laws of their land.
- e) Student Council members will be placed ____ duty at all the school gates during dispersal time.
- f) The company officials have been working on the project ____ years and it is still not complete.
- g) The captain entered ____ a pact with the players.
- h) The girl takes ____ her mother.

iii) Change the degree of the following sentences according to the instructions given after each. Choose the correct options. [4]

1) No other boy in the class is as smart as Amir. (*End with: class.*)

- a) Amir is the most smartest boy in the class.
- b) Amir is more smarter than any other boy in the class.
- c) Amir is one of the smartest boys in the class.
- d) Amir is the smartest boy in the class.

2) This smartphone is the most advanced in the market. (Use: 'more advanced')

- a) This smartphone is more advanced than most other smartphones.**
- b) No other smartphone is more advanced than this.**
- c) This smartphone is more advanced than any other smartphone in the market.**
- d) This smartphone is more advanced than all phones.**

3) Very few flowers in the garden are as fragrant as Rose. (Change the degree)

- a) Rose is one of the most fragrant flowers in the garden.**
- b) No other flower in the garden is as fragrant as Rose.**
- c) Rose is more fragrant than most flowers in the garden.**
- d) Rose is the most fragrant flower in the garden.**

4) Eye is one of the most important organs in our body. (End with: eye.)

- a) No other organ in our body is as important as eye.**
- b) Very few organs in our body are as important as eye.**
- c) One of the most important organs in our body is known as eye.**
- d) Other organs in our body are as important as eye.**

iv) Rewrite the following sentences according to the instructions given after each. Make other changes but do not change the meaning of each sentence. Choose the correct options. [8]

1) The banks are not open today. The schools are not open today. (Join the following sentences to make one complete sentence without using and, but or so.)

- a) Neither the banks nor the schools are open today.**
- b) The banks as well as the schools are closed.**
- c) Neither the banks nor the schools are not open today.**
- d) Both the banks and schools are not open today.**

2) You finish your work early. You can leave. (Join into a complex sentence)

- a) Although you finish your work early, you can leave.**
- b) If you finish your work early, you can leave.**
- c) While you finish your work early, you can leave.**
- d) Unless you finish your work early, you can leave.**

3) I left my keys somewhere. Do you know where they are? *(Join the following sentences to make one complete sentence without using and, but or so.)*

- a) Do you know where I had left my keys?
- b) Do you know where my keys were left behind?
- c) Do you know where I left my keys?
- d) Do you know where I would have left my keys?

4) It is so hot and humid that I cannot sleep. *(Use : too)*

- a) Too hot and humid it is to sleep.
- b) It is too hot and humid for me to sleep.
- c) It is hot and too humid, so I cannot sleep.
- d) It is too hot and humid such that I cannot sleep.

5) As she was not there, I spoke to her sister. *(Identify the correct clause)*

- a) As she was not there, I spoke to her sister. (Noun Clause)
- b) As she was not there, I spoke to her sister. (Adjective Clause)
- c) As she was not there, I spoke to her sister. (Adverb Clause)
- d) As she was not there, I spoke to her sister. (Noun Clause)

6) He finished his homework. His friends were waiting for him. *(Join the two sentences using an adverb clause)*

- a) Although his friends were waiting for him, he finished his homework.
- b) He finished his homework while his friends were waiting for him.
- c) Because his friends were waiting for him, he finished his homework.
- d) Both a and b

7) Olena likes stories that have fairies in them. *(Identify the correct clause)*

- a) Olena likes stories that have fairies in them. (Noun Clause)
- b) Olena likes stories that have fairies in them. (Adjective Clause)
- c) Olena likes stories that have fairies in them. (Adverb Clause)
- d) Olena likes stories that have fairies in them. (Adjective Clause)

8) Nithi is not keeping well. She decided to go to work. *(Join to form a compound sentence)*

- a) Nithi is not keeping well yet she decided to go to work.
- b) Although Nithi is not keeping well, yet she decided to go to work.
- c) Nithi is not keeping well, still she decided to go to work.
- d) Even though Nithi is not keeping well, he decided to go to work.